

TEK4090

Introduction to Modern Control

Lecture 3: State Space Systems

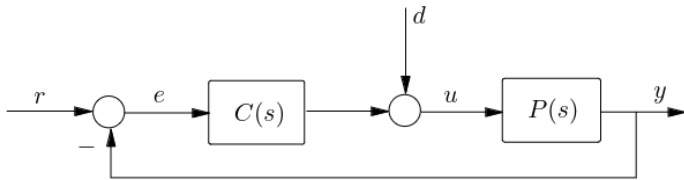
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August 27, 2025

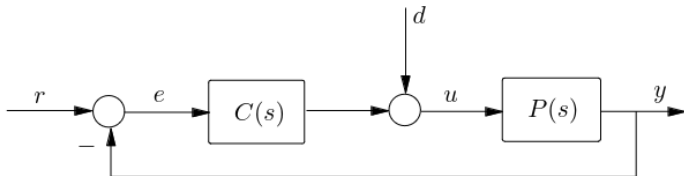
Reading Assignment

1. Francis: Ch 4.5, Ch 5
2. Åstrom & Murray: Ch 5-6, Ch 7.1

Standard Feedback Control



Theorem of Stability for Feedback Control



Theorem

The closed-loop feedback system is stable if and only if the zeros of the **characteristic polynomial**

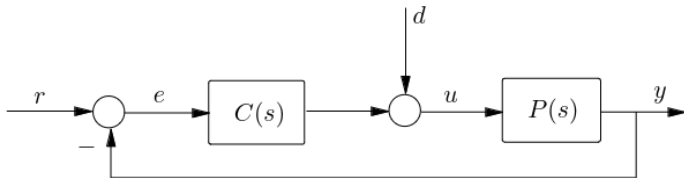
$$D_p D_c + N_p N_c \quad (1)$$

are all in the open left-hand plane.

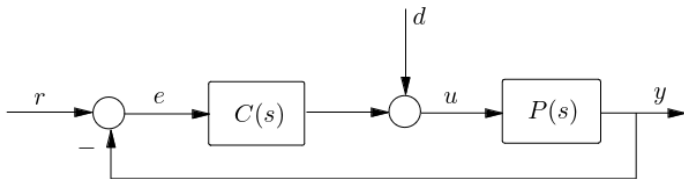
Example 1

Example 2

We saw the transfer function from e to u ...



All the Transfer Functions



$$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ U \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{1+PC} & -\frac{P}{1+PC} \\ \frac{C}{1+PC} & \frac{1}{1+PC} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} R \\ D \end{bmatrix} \quad (2)$$

Eg., transfer function from D to E is:

$$-\frac{P}{1+PC} \quad (3)$$

Reference Tracking: Motivation

Reference Tracking: Final Value

Theorem

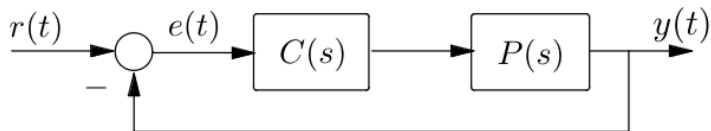
Consider a signal $f(t)$ with (rational, strictly proper) Laplace transform $F(s)$

- ▶ If $F(s)$ has no poles in $\Re(s) \geq 0$, then $f(t)$ has a final value: $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} f(t) = 0$
- ▶ If $F(s)$ has no poles in $\Re(s) \geq 0$ except a simple pole at $s = 0$, then

$$\lim_{s \rightarrow 0} sF(s) \tag{4}$$

- ▶ In all other cases, f is unstable, so $\lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} f(t) = \infty$

Reference Tracking



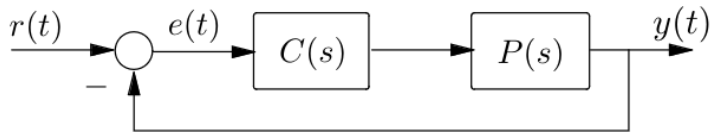
$$P(s) = \frac{1}{s+1}$$

$$C(s) = 1$$

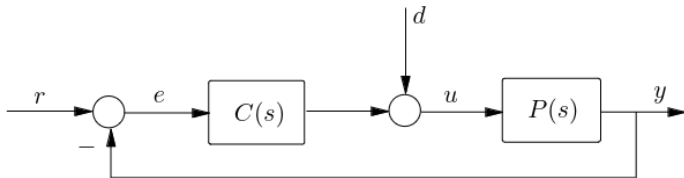
$$R(s) = \frac{100}{s}$$

This is a simple model for cruise control

Reference Tracking

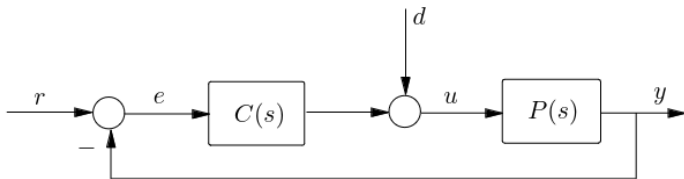


Recap from Last Time



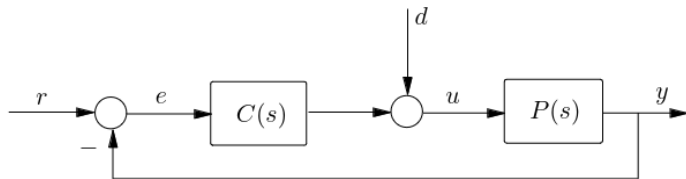
- ▶ Plant $P(s)$: Laplace-domain model of our system
- ▶ Controller $C(s)$: Takes measurement y and modifies input $u(t)$
- ▶ Reference $r(t)$: A pre-determined signal that tells the system what to do

Recap: Group of Four



$$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ U \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{1+PC} & -\frac{P}{1+PC} \\ \frac{C}{1+PC} & \frac{1}{1+PC} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} R \\ D \end{bmatrix} \quad (5)$$

Recap: Stability



Stability was equivalent to:

$$N_p N_c + D_p D_c$$

having no zeros in RHP.

$$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ U \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{1 + PC} & -\frac{P}{1 + PC} \\ \frac{C}{1 + PC} & \frac{1}{1 + PC} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} R \\ D \end{bmatrix}$$

Today

- ▶ Nyquist Stability Criterion
- ▶ Nyquist Plots
- ▶ Bode Plots
- ▶ State-Space Systems
- ▶ Reachability/Observability

Recall Complex Integration

The integral of f in a closed curve in $\mathbb{C}$ is related to the **singularities** of f .

$$\oint_{\mathcal{C}} f(s) ds = 2\pi i \sum_{z_k \in \mathcal{C}} \text{res}(f, z_k) \quad (6)$$

The residues of poles are easily computed.

Stability

The main idea:

- ▶ Stability of the feedback system is determined by RHP poles of

$$\frac{1}{1 + P(s)C(s)}. \quad (7)$$

- ▶ This is equivalent to zeros of the characteristic polynomial

$$N_p N_c + D_p D_c \quad (8)$$

- ▶ We want a nice graphical test of whether or not a system is stable
- ▶ **Idea:** can we use complex integration to tell us something?

The Argument of a Complex Number

Polar representation of complex number:

$$z = a + ib = re^{i\phi}.$$

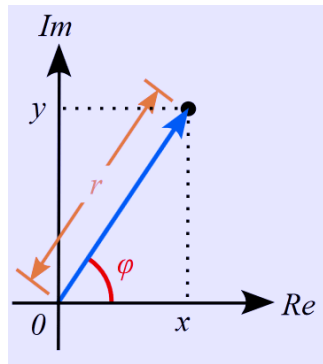
The angle ϕ is also called the **argument**.

Taking the log:

$$i\phi = \ln \frac{z}{r}$$

(9)

(10)



How does the argument of a function change?

$$i \arg z = \ln \frac{z}{|z|}$$

The total change of argument on a curve can be computed as,

Recall:

$$\frac{d}{dz} \ln f(z) = \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)}$$

$$\frac{1}{i} \oint_{\mathcal{C}} \frac{f'(z)}{f(z)} dz \quad (11)$$

For 'nice' functions, this counts zeros and poles!

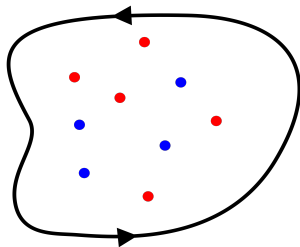
This gives us the 'rate of change' of the argument

Cauchy's Principle of the Argument



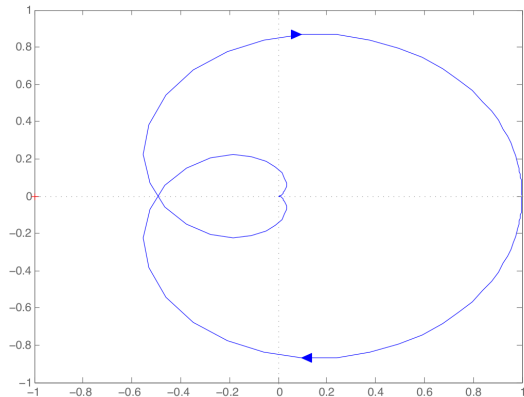
Let G be a meromorphic function, and $\mathcal{C}$ be a closed CW curve in $\mathbb{C}$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta \arg G(s) &= \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{\mathcal{C}} \frac{G'(z)}{G(z)} dz \\ &= \sum_{p_k \in \mathcal{C}} (1) - \sum_{z_k \in \mathcal{C}} (1) \\ &= n - m\end{aligned}$$



What is this saying?

How **windy** a function is on $\mathcal{C}$ tells us how many poles and zeros it has in the RHP

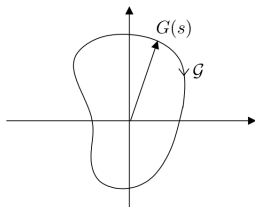
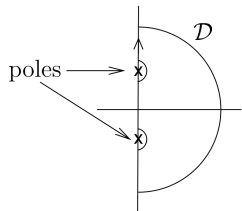


This function **winds** around 0 'negative' twice CCW, so $n - m = 2$

If we additionally know that this function has two zeros in $\mathcal{C}$, then we know that it has zero poles inside $\mathcal{C}$.

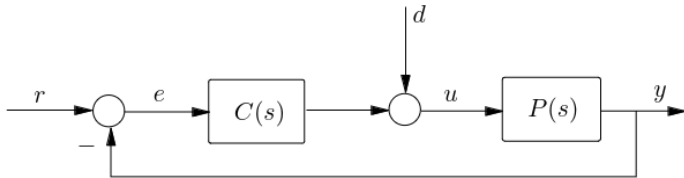
Nyquist Stability Criterion

We care about poles/zeros in the RHP for stability



- ▶ Take a closed curve $\mathcal{D}$ in RHP
- ▶ Look at its image $\mathcal{G}$ under $G(s)$
- ▶ **Argument principle:** How many times $G(s)$ circles around the origin is $(\# \text{poles} - \# \text{zeros})$ in $\mathcal{D}$.

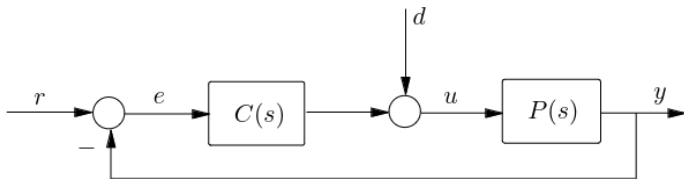
Setup



Assumptions:

1. $P(s)$, $C(s)$ are proper with at least one strictly proper
2. $P(s)C(s)$ has no pole-zero cancellations in $\Re(s) \geq 0$

Nyquist Criterion



$$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ U \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{1 + PC} & -\frac{P}{1 + PC} \\ \frac{1}{1 + PC} & \frac{1}{1 + PC} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} R \\ D \end{bmatrix}$$

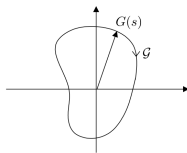
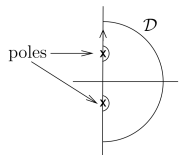
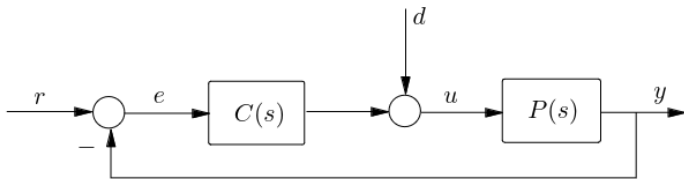
- ▶ No pole-zero cancellations:

$$D_p D_c + N_p N_c, \quad 1 + P(s)C(s) := G(s)$$

have the same RHP zeros

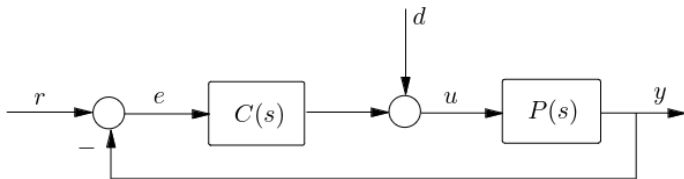
- ▶ Stability $\iff G(s)$ no RHP zeros

Nyquist Criterion



- ▶ Proper: $G(s)$ has more poles than zeros
- ▶ n poles, m zeros in RHP
- ▶ Stability $\iff m = 0$
- ▶ $G(s)$ circles origin n times CCW
- ▶ Alternately, $P(s)G(s)$ circles -1 , n times CCW

Nyquist Criterion: Final Statement



$$\begin{bmatrix} E \\ U \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{1 + PC} & -\frac{P}{1 + PC} \\ \frac{1}{1 + PC} & \frac{1}{1 + PC} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} R \\ D \end{bmatrix}$$

- ▶ Let n denote the number of poles of $P(s)C(s)$ in $\Re(s) \geq 0$
- ▶ The feedback system is stable iff the Nyquist plot doesn't pass through -1 and encircles it exactly n times CCW

Nyquist Logic Summarized

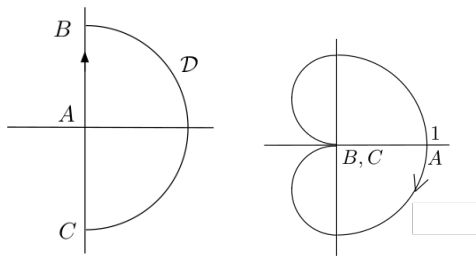
- ▶ The feedback loop is stable if the characteristic polynomial

$$D_p D_c + N_p N_c \quad (12)$$

has no RHP zeros.

- ▶ Equivalent to $G(s) = 1 + P(s)C(s)$ having no zeros
- ▶ Principle of the argument says that $\mathcal{G} = 1 + P(s)C(s)$ encircles the origin (or, $P(s)C(s)$ encircles -1) $n - m$ times CCW
- ▶ Therefore, $m = 0$ ($G(s)$ has no RHP zeros) iff $\mathcal{G}$ encircles the origin n times CCW
- ▶ Therefore, feedback stability iff $P(s)C(s)$ encircles -1 exactly n times CCW

Nyquist Plot Example 1



$$P(s)C(s) = \frac{1}{(s+1)^2}$$

On segment $A \rightarrow B$, $s = j\omega$, and so

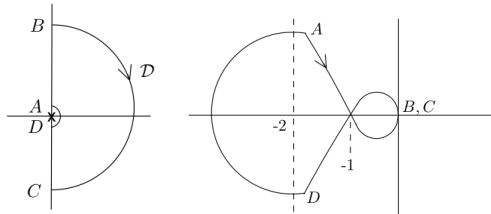
$$\Re PC = \frac{1 - \omega^2}{(1 - \omega^2)^2 + (2\omega)^2}$$

$$\Im PC = \frac{-2\omega}{(1 - \omega^2)^2 + (2\omega)^2}$$

$$PC(0) = 1.$$

As s approaches B , $PC(j\omega) \mapsto -1/\omega^2$

Nyquist Plot Example 2



$$P(s)C(s) = \frac{s+1}{s(s-1)}$$

(Just use Matlab...)

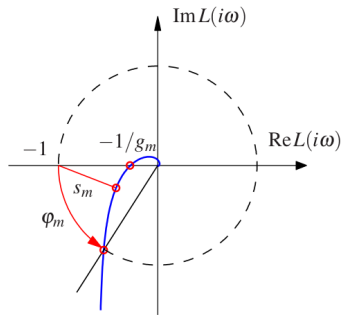
Nyquist Plots

Nyquist Properties

- ▶ Scales by constants:
 - ▶ Eg., constant gain $C(s) = kH(s)$
 - ▶ If the plot crosses -1 for some K , then we can see this easily
- ▶ Otherwise, not super useful for **designing** controllers

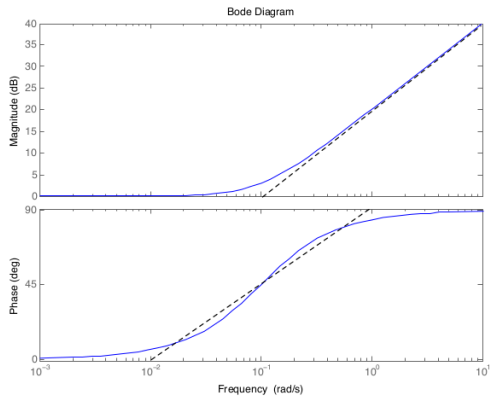
Nyquist Plots

Punchline: Encirclements (or de-encirclements) stabilize (or destabilize) the system



1. **Gain Margin:** g_m : how much we can scale the plot
2. **Phase Margin:** how much phase a $C(s)$ can add
3. **Stability Margin:** shortest distance to -1

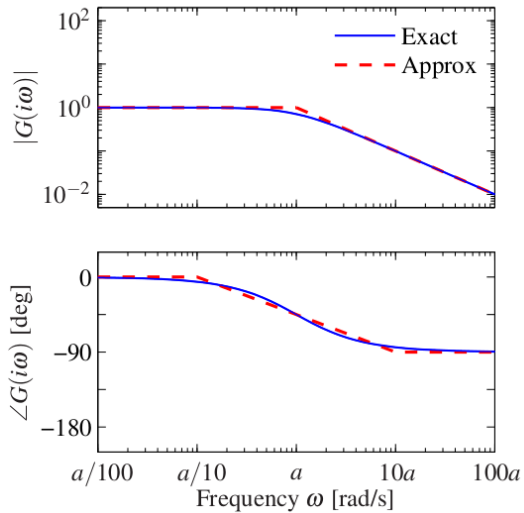
Bode Plots



1. **Magnitude** (in dB): $|G(j\omega)|$
2. **Phase** (in deg): $\arg G(j\omega)$

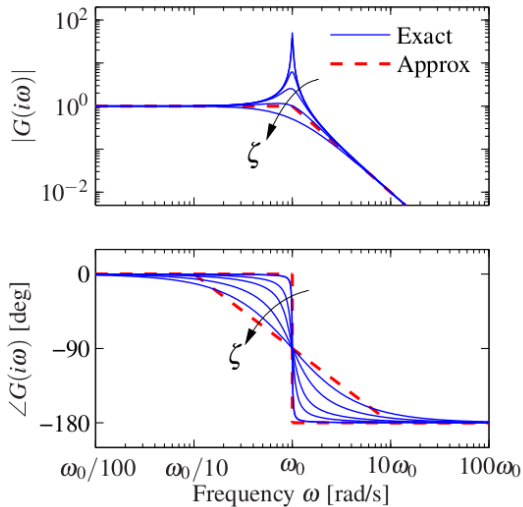
$$G(s) = 10s + 1 \quad (13)$$

Bode Plots: Examples



$$G(s) = \frac{a}{s+a} \quad (14)$$

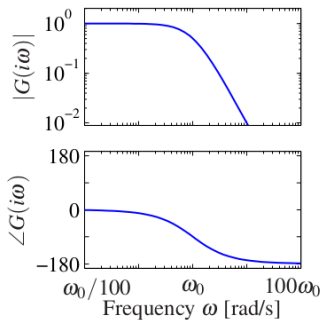
Bode Plots: Examples



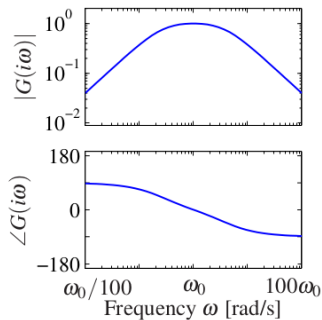
$$G(s) = \frac{\omega_0^2}{s^2 + 2\zeta\omega_0 s + \omega_0^2} \quad (15)$$

- ▶ Resonant peak at ω_0
- ▶ Height of peak: damping ζ

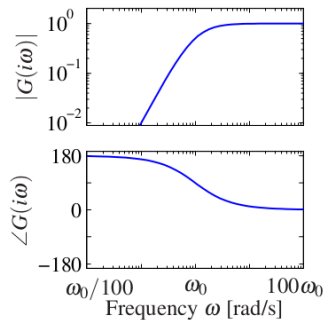
Bode Plots: Filters



$$G(s) = \frac{\omega_0^2}{s^2 + 2\zeta\omega_0 s + \omega_0^2}$$

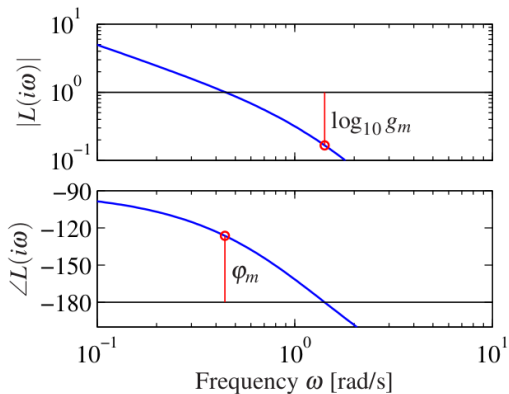


$$G(s) = \frac{2\zeta\omega_0 s}{s^2 + 2\zeta\omega_0 s + \omega_0^2}$$



$$G(s) = \frac{s^2}{s^2 + 2\zeta\omega_0 s + \omega_0^2}$$

Stability margins



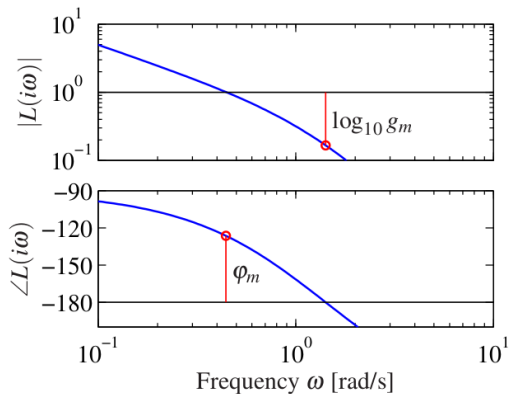
► Gain Crossover Frequency:

$$\omega_{gc} := \min_{\omega \in \mathbb{R}} \{|L(i\omega)| = 10\text{dB}\}$$

► Phase Margin:

$$\varphi_m := \pi + \arg L(i\omega_{gc})$$

Stability margins



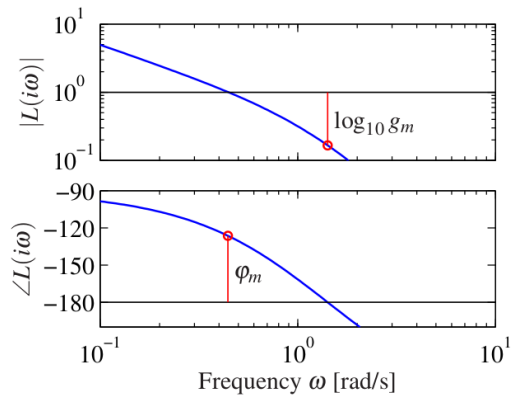
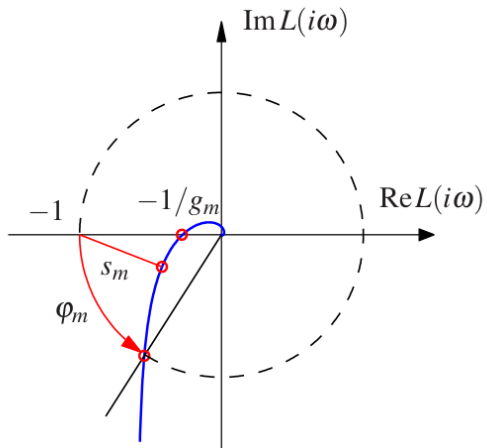
► Phase Crossover Frequency:

$$\omega_{pc} := \min_{\omega \in \mathbb{R}} \{ \arg L(i\omega) = 180^\circ \}$$

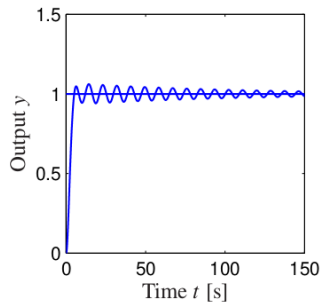
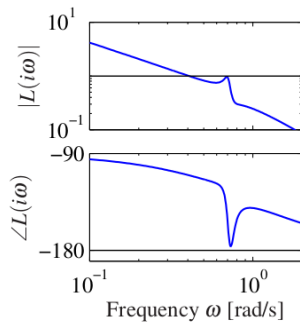
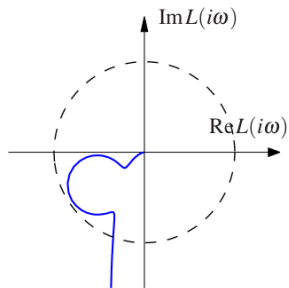
► Gain Margin:

$$g_m := \frac{1}{|L(i\omega_{pc})|}$$

Nyquist vs Bode



Good Gain/Phase Margin, Poor Stability Margin



State-Space Systems

Linear Systems

$$\dot{x} = Ax + Bu \quad (16)$$

$$y = Cx \quad (17)$$

Matrix Exponential

Defined in terms of its Taylor expansion

$$e^a = 1 + a + \frac{a^2}{2!} + \frac{a^3}{3!} + \cdots = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{a^k}{k!} \quad (18)$$

$$e^A = I + A + \frac{A^2}{2!} + \frac{A^3}{3!} + \cdots = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \frac{A^k}{k!} \quad (19)$$

So, the derivative:

$$\frac{d}{dt} e^{At} = \frac{d}{dt} \left(I + At + \frac{A^2 t^2}{2!} + \frac{A^3 t^3}{3!} + \cdots \right) = A e^{At} \quad (20)$$

Existence of Solutions

Theorem

A solution to the ODE is given by

$$x(t) = e^{At}x_0 + \int_0^t e^{A(t-\tau)}Bu(\tau)d\tau \quad (21)$$

Proof: Take derivative w.r.t t

Diagonalizable Matrices

Theorem

A matrix A is called **diagonalizable** if there exists T such that

$$D = TAT^{-1}, \quad (22)$$

where D is a diagonal matrix containing the eigenvalues of A .

Then, we can write the system matrix exponential as,

$$e^{At} = Te^{Dt}T^{-1}. \quad (23)$$

Non-Diagonalizable Matrices

Complicated, but happens when you have repeated eigenvalues

$$A = TJT^{-1}$$

Jordan form:

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} J_1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & J_2 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & J_{k-1} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & J_k \end{bmatrix}$$

$$J_i = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda_i & 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \lambda_i & 1 & \cdots & 0 & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & \lambda_i & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & \lambda_i \end{bmatrix}$$

Matrix Exponential of Jordan Form

$$e^A = Te^J T^{-1} \quad (24)$$

$$e^J = \begin{bmatrix} e^{J_1} & & & \\ & e^{J_2} & & \\ & & \ddots & \\ & & & e^{J_k} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$e^{J_i} = e^{\lambda_i} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & t & \frac{t^2}{2} & \cdots & \frac{t^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} \\ 0 & 1 & t & \cdots & \frac{t^{n-2}}{(n-2)!} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & t \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Eigenvalues and Modes

Coordinate Invariance

The coordinate frame chosen to represent the states/inputs x and u affects the values of A , B and C .

Recall from the linear algebra class that a map $z = Tx$ with T invertible can represent a linear coordinate shift.

$$\frac{dz}{dt} = T(Ax + Bu) = TAT^{-1}z + TBu \quad (25)$$

$$y = Cx + Du = CT^{-1}z + Du \quad (26)$$

or

$$\dot{z} = \tilde{A}z + \tilde{B}u, \quad \tilde{A} = TAT^{-1}, \quad \tilde{B} = TB \quad (27)$$

$$y = \tilde{C}z + Du, \quad \tilde{C} = CT^{-1} \quad (28)$$

Coordinate Invariance

Using the property

$$e^{TST^{-1}} = Te^S T^{-1}, \quad (29)$$

it can be shown that

$$x(t) = T^{-1}z(t) = T^{-1}e^{\tilde{A}t}Tx(t) + T^{-1}\int_0^t e^{\tilde{A}(t-\tau)}\tilde{B}u(\tau)d\tau \quad (30)$$

Steady-State Response

Output system:

$$y(t) = Ce^{At}x_0 + \int_0^t Ce^{A(t-\tau)}Bu(\tau)d\tau \quad (31)$$

Nonlinear systems & Linearization

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dx}{dt} &= f(x, u), \quad x \in \mathbb{R}^n, u \in \mathbb{R} \\ y &= h(x, u), \quad y \in \mathbb{R}\end{aligned}$$

Consider an **equilibrium point** (x_e, u_e) such that $f(x_e, u_e) = 0$, and variables such that

$$\begin{aligned}z &= x - x_e \\ v &= u - u_e \\ w &= y - h(x_e, u_e)\end{aligned}$$

The **Jacobian linearization** of the system is,

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{dz}{dt} &= Az + Bv, \quad w = Cz + Dv \\ A &= \left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial x} \right|_{(x_e, u_e)}, \quad B = \left. \frac{\partial f}{\partial u} \right|_{(x_e, u_e)} \\ C &= \left. \frac{\partial h}{\partial x} \right|_{(x_e, u_e)}, \quad D = \left. \frac{\partial h}{\partial u} \right|_{(x_e, u_e)}\end{aligned}$$

Example: Vehicle Steering

Example: Vehicle Steering

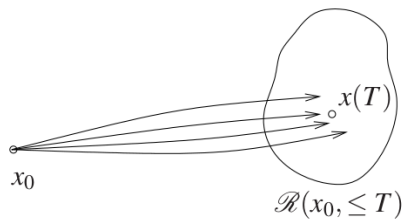
Reachability

Quick Note

For clarity, we will consider systems with a single input and single output (SISO), i.e. $u(t), y(t) \in \mathbb{R}$, and so $B \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 1}$ and $C \in \mathbb{R}^{1 \times n}$.

All the final results hold if you consider MIMO systems as well

Reachability



The **reachable set** $\mathcal{R}(x_0, T)$ is the set of all points x_f such that there exists an input $u(t)$ that steers the system from $x(0) = x_0$ to $x(T) = x_f$.

A system is **reachable** if for any $x_0, x_f \in \mathbb{R}^n$, there exists $T > 0$ and $u : [0, T] \mapsto \mathbb{R}$ such that $x(0) = x_0$ and $x(T) = x_f$.

Test for Reachability

Test for Reachability

Test for Reachability

Test for Reachability

Theorem

A linear system is reachable if and only if the reachability matrix W_r is invertible.

Reachable Canonical Form

$$\frac{dz}{dt} = \begin{bmatrix} -a_1 & -a_2 & -a_3 & \cdots & -a_n \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & & & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} z + \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} u,$$
$$y = [b_1 \quad b_2 \quad b_2 \quad \cdots \quad b_n] z + Du$$

$$W_r = [B \quad AB \quad \cdots \quad A^{n-1}B]$$
$$= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -a_1 & a_1^2 - a_2 & \cdot & * \\ 0 & 1 & -a_1 & \cdot & * \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & * \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

How do we convert a system to this form?

Conversion to Reachable Canonical Form

Conversion to Reachable Canonical Form

Conversion to Reachable Canonical Form

Summary of Today

- ▶ Nyquist Stability
- ▶ Stability Margins
- ▶ Nyquist & Bode Plots
- ▶ Linear State-Space Systems Theory

Next Time:

- ▶ MATLAB Lecture
- ▶ Some tools for transfer functions and Bode/Nyquist plots